WIKIPEDIA
The Free Encyclopedia

Sabarimala Temple

The **Sabarimala Sree Dharma Sastha Temple**[1] (Malayalam pronunciation: [ʃabərimala]), is a Hindu temple dedicated to the God Dharma Sastha where the deity is worshipped as Lord Ayyappan, the son of the deities Shiva and Mohini (female avatar of the god Vishnu),[2] and is situated atop the Sabarimala hill in Ranni-Perunad village of Ranni Taluk in Thiruvalla Revenue Division of Pathanamthitta district in the Kerala state of India. The temple is surrounded by 18 hills in the Periyar Tiger Reserve.[3] It is one of the largest annual pilgrimage sites in the world, with an estimate of over 10 to 15 million devotees visiting every year.[4][5][6][7]

The temple is open for worship only during the days of *Mandala Pooja* (approximately 15 November to 26 December),[8] *Makaravilakku* or Makara Sankranti (14 January), Maha Thirumal Sankranti (14 April), and the first five days of each Malayalam month. The Sabarimala Temple serves as a prime example of the amalgamation of several religious traditions within the Indian context.[9]

The temple practices prohibit women between the ages of 10 and 50 years from accessing the temple premises. This restriction was lifted by the Supreme Court of India after a case was filed by five hindi speaking North Indian women advocates from Delhi including Prerana Kumari, who is the official spokesperson of the Purvanchal Morcha and the secretary of the BJP legal Cell Supreme court unit.[10]

Sabarimala Sree Dharma Shasta Temple

The temple of Ayyappan in Sabarimala, Kerala

Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Pathanamthitta
Deity	Dharmasastha's yogic avatar as Ayyappan
Festivals	Makaravilakku, Makara Sankranti (14 January)
Governing body	Travancore Devaswom Board
Status	Only open during certain occasions
Location	
Location	Sabarimala
State	Kerala
Country	India

Origins and legends

According to *Bhagavata Purana*, god Shiva lay with god Vishnu while the latter was in the female Mohini form. Their carnal union resulted in the conception of the deity Shasta. Shasta is also known as

Hariharaputra, the son of Hari (Vishnu) and Hara (Shiva).[11] It is believed that Ayyappa is a form of Shasta.[12]

The worship of Shasta forms part of the ancient history of South India.[13] There are many Shasta temples in South India and across the globe.[14]

Five Shasta temples, namely those in Kulathupuzha, Aryankavu, Achankovil, Sabarimala, and Ponnambalmedu, are said to be linked to Parashurama, an avatar of Vishnu.[15] In Kulathupuzha, Shasta is venerated as a child deity. In the Aryankavu temple, he is worshipped as an adolescent *Brahmachari*. The Achankovil temple is connected to the deity's Grihastha (household), where he is shown sitting on a horse and holding a sword, along with his wives, Pushkala and Poorna. The Sabarimala temple is associated with the deity's Vanaprastha, and in the Ponnambalmedu or Kantamala temple, the deity is shown as the greatest *Yogi*.[15][16]

Legend of Manikandan

Sage Suta told his followers the story of how Ayyappa was born, according to *Bhutnathopakhyanam*, a text for Ayyappan followers. After Chamundi killed Mahisasura, his sister Mahisi arrived to take revenge on the *devas* (gods). Brahma gave Mahishi a boon that made her invincible, with the caveat that only a human born of two males could kill her. The devas were afraid and helpless, so they sought assistance from Vishnu. The union of Shiva and Vishnu, who took the avatar of Mohini, produced a son named Manikandan.

Manikandan was abandoned on the banks of the Pampa River in southern India. The emperor Rajasekhara of the Panthalam dynasty, who was child less, found this child. In the meantime, the queen delivered a baby. The queen disliked Manikandan and devised a scheme to eliminate him. She lied about her sickness, claiming that she could only be treated by consuming tiger's milk. Twelve-year-old Manikandan ventured into the wilderness in search of tiger's milk for his adoptive mother. On his journey through the forest, he killed Mahisi. The devas were pleased at Mahishi's death. Indra assumed the appearance of a

Sabarimala Temple (Kerala)

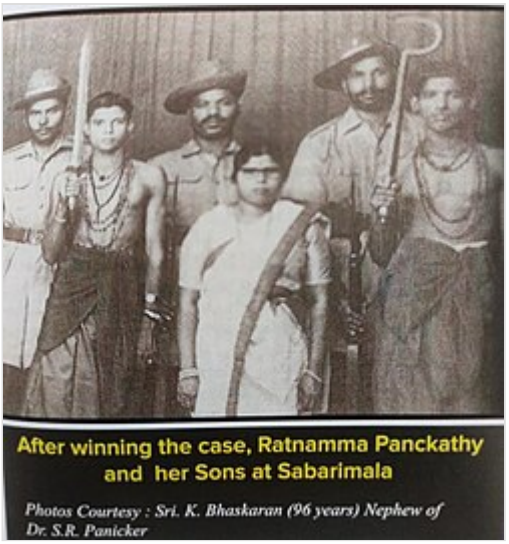
Sabarimala Temple (India)

Coordinates	9°26′04.6″N 77°04′53.0″E
Architecture	
Type	Kerala Architecture (Traditional Kerala Vastu Shastra)
Creator	As per tradition Vishwakarma,Pandhalam King Rajasekhara, (sculptor) is believed to be Parashurama
Completed	11th century; the temple site is older
Elevation	1,260 m (4,134 ft)
Website	
sabarimala.kerala.gov.in (https://sabarimala.kerala.gov.in/)	

tiger, which Manikandan used to return to the kingdom. He flung an arrow into the forest to mark the location of a temple, directed them to construct a temple, and then departed for *Devaloka* (the devas' abode).[17]

Legend of Malikapurathamma

Cheerappanchira is an ancient noble Ezhava family from Muhamma in Alappuzha District. According to mythology, Maalikapurathamma is the divine daughter of Cheerappanchira Panicker.[18][19][20] Ayyappan was sent by the Pandalam king to Muhamma to learn Kalaripayattu. Malikkapurathamma, also known as Subhadra, taught kalari to Ayyappan in the absence of her father. During this time, she fell love with Ayyappan, but Ayyappan remained celibate. The Cheerappanchira family holds the rights to conduct fireworks, to light Nilavilak and ceremonial lamps at the Malikapurathamma temple, and collect half of the coconuts donated by the devotees at the Malikapurathamma temple.[21] Valiya Kadutha swamy and Kochu Kadutha swamy are warriors worshipped at the temple and are considered as Shaundikans.[22]



After winning the case and gaining hereditary rights to conduct fireworks at Sabarimala, Ratnamma Panickathy from Cheerappanchira and her sons at Sabarimala.

Connection with Rama

Shabari was a tribal devotee of Rama who is mentioned in the Ramayana. Sabarimala literally translates to "the hill of Sabari."[23]

As per legend, Sabari met Sage Matanga near the foot of Mount Rishyamukha. He became her guru, and she devotedly served him for years. When Matanga was on his deathbed, he foretold that Rama would come to grant her darshan. He told her to wait for the arrival of Rama. Since that time, Sabari would leave her ashram each day only to gather berries for Rama. She would pick one, taste it, and place it in her basket if it was sweet, discarding the bitter berries because she wanted Rama to have only the sweet berries. While searching for Sita, Rama visits Sabari at her ashram. Sabari fed Rama with the berries that she had collected.[24]

Rama saw a divine person doing penance and asked Shabari to tell him who it was. Shabari said it was Sastha (Ayyappan). Sastha also stood and greeted Rama.[23][24]

The temple

History

The Sabarimala temple does not have any ancient or medieval references. Nevertheless, there are extant late medieval references pertaining to the temple.

The Pandalam royal family drafted a mortgage document in 1793. It states that the royal family is pledging the revenue returns, which encompass the income generated by the Sabarimala Temple, to the Tranvancore state.[25]

In 1863, Ward and Conner published an article that provided a description of Sabarimala and its vicinity.[26]

In the year 1902, the ruler of Travancore issued a directive for the restoration of the Sabarimala temple, which had suffered damage as a result of a fire incident. Kochummen Muthalali of Polachirackal family, a Mavelikkara resident of Christian faith, funded and carried out the reconstruction contract.[27]

In the year 1950 the temple was rebuilt after an arson attack.[28] No charges were brought,[29] and the earlier stone image of the deity was replaced by a panchaloha (an alloy of five metals) idol, about one and a half feet tall.

Neelakanta Panicker and his younger brother, Ayyappa Panicker, who are members of the Thattavila Vishwakarma family in Chengannur, Kerala, created the Panchaloha idol to replace the original stone statue of the deity. Edavankadan T.N. Padmanabhan Achari from Mavaelikkara was appointed the supervisor in charge of the new idol by Rajpramukh Sree Chithira Tirunaal Balarama Varma.[30] In the early 1950s, through P. T. Rajan efforts, the present panchaloha idol of Ayyappan was installed at Sabarimalai, and a procession was taken all over Madras state.[31][32]

In 1969, the flagstaff (*dhwajastambha*) was installed.[33]

Sabarimala Picture gallery

The main temple

Sabaripeedam

Pathinettampadi, the 18 steps which lead to the sanctum

The sanctum sanctorum

Architecture and shrines

The *Sannidhanam* (main temple) is built on a plateau about 40 feet high.[34][35][36]

The temple consists of a sanctum sanctorum with a gold-plated roof and four golden finials at the top, two *mandapams*, and the *balikalpura*, which houses the altar.[37]

The 18 sacred steps are the main stairway to the temple. As per the custom followed, no pilgrim without "Irumudikkettu" can ascend the 18 sacred steps. In 1985, the 18 steps were covered by Panchaloha. The temples of Ayyappan's trusted lieutenants, Karuppannaswamy and Kadutha Sami, are positioned as his guards (kaval) at the foot of the holy 18 sacred steps.

The northern gate is open for those who do not carry an "Irumudikkettu", as observed in the 1991 Kerala High Court judgement.[38]

Ayyappan's half-brother Kannimoola Ganapathy's shrine is southwest of the sanctum. Devotees offer part of the broken coconut (Neythenga) to the fireplace (Azhi). Ganapati homam is the main offering.[36]

The temple of *Maalikapurathamma*, whose importance is almost on par with that of Ayyappan, is located a few yards from Sannidhanam. It is believed that Ayyappan had specific instructions that he wanted *Malikappurath Amma* on his left side. Prior to the fire damage, there was only a Peeda Prathishta (holy seat) at Malikappuram. Brahmasree Kandararu Maheswararu Thanthri installed the idol of Malikappurath Amma. The goddess holds a Sankh, Chakram and Varada Abhya Mudra. The idol is now covered with a gold golaka. The temple was also reconstructed in the last decade, and the conical roof and *sopanam* are also covered with gold.[39]

The shrine of the king of the snakes, Nagaraja, is adjacent to the Malikappurathamma temple. Pilgrims, after the Darsan of Ayyappa and Kannimoola Ganapathi, proceed for their darshan of and give offerings to Nagaraja.

Nagaraja Shrine at Sabarimala

Manimandapam is the place where Ayyappan vanished into the temple.[39]

The Sabarimala temple complex includes *Pampa Ganapathi* temple, *Nilakal Mahadeva* temple, and *Palliyarakkavu Devi Temple*. The Nilakal Mahadeva temple and Palliyarakkavu Devi Temple are as old as the Ayyappan temple, and the deities are worshipped as the parents of Ayyappan. Ganapathi temple at Pampa houses *Pampa Maha Ganapathi* and *Athi Ganapathi* (lit. old Ganesha) idols; in Sreekovil, the idol from the first Ganesha temple is worshipped. *Sabari Peedam* has a temple for Rama and Hanuman as well.

Administration

Administration and legal binding is managed by Travancore Devasvom Board, an affiliate authority of Government of Kerala. Thazhamon Madom, during the King's rule appointed was the traditional priest of Sabarimala Temple. Tantri is the highest priest and is the head of the temple. It's the duty of the family to decide on religious matters relating to Sabarimala shrine. Tantris are to be present in all ceremonial Poojas and functions to be held at temple premises and functions associated with temple. On 2025, High court of Kerala reached a verdict that everyone are eligible to the thantri of the temple, irrespective of their castes. This was in response to the case filed by the organization of Nambudiri brahmins to restrict entry of other castes as priest in temples in Kerala.[40]

Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) has decided to allow more devotees daily to visit the Sabarimala Ayyappa temple as of 1 December 2020. The number of devotees has been increased from the present 1,000 to 2,000 on week days and from 2,000 to 3,000 on weekends and holidays.

All necessary precautionary measures have been taken at the shrine premises and base camps adhering to COVID-19 guidelines.[41]

2025-30 upgrade plan

In 2025, ₹1,033 crore plan was unveiled by the Government of Kerala for the upgrade of *Sannidhanam* (entire temple complex encompassing the holy shrine of Lord Ayyappa and the sanctum sanctorum, the *Pathinettaampadi* with eighteen sacred steps, and other associated structures), hill trek for pilgrimage to the temple complex, and the Pamba town at foothill which is the base camp for the pilgrimage. Under the plan following will be spent:[42]

- 2025-28: ₹300 crore for the improvement of the basic facilities for the devotees,
- 2025-28 Phase-1: ₹600.47 crore for the improvement of the basic facilities for the devotees,
- 2028-33 Phase-2: ₹100.02 crore for the improvement of the basic facilities for the devotees,
- 2034-39 Phase-3: ₹Rs 77.68 crore for the improvement of the basic facilities for the devotees.[42]

Religious practices

Tattvamasi: guiding hymn

At the Sabarimala temple, "Tattvamasi" is a guiding spiritual concept, often associated with the temple's ethos of equality and unity among devotees, regardless of caste, creed, or status. It is inscribed at the temple and reflects the philosophical underpinning of Lord Ayyappa's teachings, emphasizing self-realization and universal oneness during the pilgrimage. The most important message written on the temple facade is one of the four Mahāvākyas of Advaita or the non-dualistic school of philosophy. Tat Tvam Asi, the 3rd of four Mahavakyas which in sanskrit translates to "Thou Art That", is the principal philosophy that governs the temple and pilgrimage. As the pilgrimage is symbolic for the journey to self-realization that all living beings possess the part and parcel of parabrahman (lord), pilgrims refer to each other as Swami, acknowledging their divinity with lord seated in everyone's heart as bramhan.

The oneness of jIva and Ishvara are qualitatively but not quantitatively described by enquiry into the inner meaning of the statement 'tat tvam asi' as follows:

- "Tat" refers to Ishvara, the lord - the word Ishvara has a literal and an implied meaning;
- The literal meaning of 'Ishvara' is 'supreme bramhan (above bramhan and para bramhan)';
- refers to the jIva, the individual identities of everyone;
- The literal meaning of 'jIva' is 'AtmA identified with mithyA gross and subtle bodies';
- The implied meaning is pure consciousness-AtmA without mithyA gross and subtle bodies;
- In advaita AtmA and parmatma (Brahman) are different names of the one Reality;
- Thus, jIva and Ishvara are Absolutely non-different in qualitatively, but only difference is quantitatively[43]

Harivarasanam: devotional song in Sanskrit language

Vadakkathillathu Eswaran Namoothiri, who held the position of *melsanthi*, a chief priest, started the tradition of singing keerthan in the year 1950. Following the *Athazhapooja*, he performed the recitation of *Harivarasanam*, a Sanskrit *Urakkupattu* (lullaby). The recitation takes place nightly before the closing of

the temple entrance. The keerthan can be found in the Sasthasthuti kadambam, a publication authored by Kambankudi Sundaram Kulathu Ayyer. The song depicts Ayappa as Hariharaputhra, a deity revered in the Vedas.[44]

Neyyabhishekam: sacred offerings to the deity

This significant ritual involves pouring sacred ghee brought by pilgrims in their *Pallikettu* or *Irumudi* (a two-compartment bag made of handwoven cotton for the offerings for Sabarimala Temple carried on their heads) on the idol of Ayyappan. It symbolically means the merging of Jeevatma with the Paramatma.

Prasadam: distribution of blessed food

The prasadam at Sabarimala temple are *Aravana payasam* and *Appam*. An 'Appam' is a sweet ball composed of rice, kadalippazham, and ghee, whereas 'Arvana' refers to a dense and sweet dessert.[45] The Chief Commissioner, Travancore Devaswom Board, said that the board has appointed the Central Food Technological Research Institute, Mysore, as a consultant for providing technical guidance to ensure the quality of Aravana, Appam, and other prasadam preparations at Sabarimala temple.[46]

Aravana Payasam

Festival

Makara Vilakku: the light of Capricorn festival

Makaravilakku is an annual festival held on Makara Sankranti in Kerala, India at the shrine of Sabarimala. *Makara Vilakku* or *Makara Sankranti* in Sanskrit means the festival of the zodiac sign Capricorn. The festival includes the *Thiruvabharanam* (sacred ornaments of the deity Ayyappan) procession and a congregation at the hill shrine of Sabarimala. An estimated half a million devotees flow to Sabarimala every year to have a darshan (glimpse) of this ritual this day.

Makarajyoti: celestial light related to Makar Sankranti capricorn festival

Makara Jyothi is the name given to the celestial star Sirius. It appears at the moment of Makar Sankranti, after which the holy arti is performed and the lighting of the Makaravilakku at Ponnambalamedu shall begin.

Five methods of worship

The customs of the pilgrims to Sabarimala are based on five worshipping methods; those of Shaivites, Shaktists and Vaishnavites. At first, there were three sections of devotees – the devotees of Shakti worship their deity by way of yajna, literally sacrifice, the devotees of Vishnu who followed the strict penance and continence, and the devotees of Shiva who partly followed these two methods. Another name of Ayyappa is Shasta. All these can be seen merged into the beliefs of pilgrims to Sabarimala. The chain the pilgrims wear comes from the Rudraksha chain of the Shaivites. The strict fasting, penance and continence is taken out of the beliefs of the Vaishnavites.

Pilgrimage

A sign-board that indicates the direction to Sabarimala. The multilingual board is written in Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil, Kannada, Telugu and English (in that order, from top to bottom).

Traditional 41 days pilgrimage

The duration of the pilgrimage to the Sabarimala temple is predetermined. Furthermore, the pilgrims are required to undergo various stages of the pilgrimage in an orderly manner.[47]

The pilgrimage to Sabarimala starts on the first day of Vrischika month of the Malayalam calendar (with Scorpio zodiac) and ends on the 11th day of Dhanu month (during Sagittarius). This duration of the 41-day pilgrimage is known as *mandala* (season) and falls in the months of December and January of the Gregorian calendar.[48]

The devotees are expected to follow a *Vratham* (a 41-day austerity period) prior to the pilgrimage.[49][50][51] This begins with wearing a special *Mala* (necklace) commonly of Rudraksha or Tulasi beads, although other types of chains are also available. During the 41 days of the pious devotion, the devotees take a vow of lacto-vegetarian diet (In India, vegetarianism is synonymous with lacto-vegetarianism), celibacy, teetotalism, not using any profanity, controlling anger, and allow the hair and nails to grow without trimming.[51] They must try to help others, and see everything around them as Ayyappa. They are expected to bathe twice a day and visit the local temples regularly and only wear plain black or blue coloured traditional attire.[52]

Crowd management of pilgrims.

Millions of devotees still take the traditional mountainous forest path (approximately 61 km) from Erumely, 12.8 km from Vandiperiyar and 8 km from Chalakayam, believed to be taken by Ayyappa himself. The Erumely route starts from Erumely to Aludha river, then crosses the Aludha mountain to reach Karivilam thodu. Now comes the sacred Karimala crossing, from there to Cheriyanavattom, Valliyanavattom and finally Pamba River. Then they have to climb Neelimala and enter the Ganesha-Bettam, Shreerama-Betta Padam. Then comes the Aranmula kottaram, which is one of the stops of holy journey *Thiruvabharana Ghoshayatra* (the grand procession of the divine jewelry).[52]

Many of these Hindu pilgrims also visit a mosque in Erumely dedicated to Vavar, a Muslim saint who according to tradition was a devotee of Ayyappan.[53]

Shorter pilgrimage

These days people use vehicles to reach the Pamba River by an alternate route. From Pamba, all the pilgrims begin trekking the steep mountain path of Neeli Mala till Sabari Mala. This route is now properly paved, with emergency shops and medical aid by the side, and supporting aid is provided to the pilgrims while climbing the steep slope, which used to be a mere trail through dense jungle. Elderly pilgrims are carried by men on bamboo chairs to the top, for a payment.[54]

Transport

KSRTC Busses are available to various places across Kerala including Chengannur, Kottayam Railway stations.

Pilgrims trekking on the path through forests leading to Sabarimala temple

Air

The nearest airports are Thiruvananthapuram International Airport (170 kilometres (110 mi) south) and Cochin International Airport (160 kilometres (99 mi) northwest). The state government has also approved the construction of the greenfield Sabarimala Greenfield Airport (50 kilometres (31 mi) west) close to the Sabarimala shrine.[55]

Railway

The nearest railway station is Chengannur known as the Gateway of Sabarimala. Chengannur (85 kilometres (53 mi) west), Tiruvalla(87 kilometres (54 mi) west)Kottayam (96 kilometres (60 mi) northwest) are some of the closest accessible railway stations from Sabarimala.

The Sabari Express train, which stops at nearby stations like Chengannur, Thiruvalla and Kottayam, is frequented by devotees of this temple. During the peak season, the train is full of devotees looking to travel to the temple.[56]

Doli service in Sabarimala

Road and bus

Special buses are arranged from different parts of the state to provide transportation to Kerala in anticipation of the yearly Mandala and Makaravilakku poojas performed at the temple dedicated to Lord Ayyappa Swamy.[57][58]

Ropeway

Sabarimala Ropeway, proposed project conceived in 2011, received impetus for construction when National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) of India granted the forests and environmental approval in August 2025.[59]

Issues and conservation

Gold theft

Sabarimala gold theft controversy involves the misappropriation and theft of approximately 4.5–12 kg of gold (valued at around ₹100 crore) used in the gold plating of the Dwarapalaka idols and other temple artifacts at the Sabarimala Temple, as revealed through audits and court scrutiny of the Travancore Devaswom Board's (TDB) handling of devotee offerings and restoration works. The issue traces back to repeated removals of gold-plated copper panels in 2019 and 2025 for repairs at workshops in Hyderabad and Chennai, where discrepancies in weight and gold content emerged, including faded plating just months after restoration and the re-engagement of a questionable sponsor, Unnikrishnan Potti (also known as Potty), despite prior concerns; on 28 September 2025, two pedestals belonging to temple were recovered from Potti's sister's residence in Thiruvananthapuram amid claims he intended to repurpose the gold for a wedding. Triggered by a Kerala High Court petition, the TDB filed a police complaint in early October, describing initial findings as "minor pilferage" rather than organized theft, while the **Sabarimala Karma Samithi** (SKS) lodged a separate FIR alleging criminal breach of trust and looting. The opposition United Democratic Front (UDF) and BJP accused the ruling Left Democratic Front (LDF) government of corruption, cover-ups, and negligence—demanding CBI involvement and resignations—leading to Assembly disruptions and statewide agitations, whereas the LDF dismissed the claims as politically motivated electioneering ahead of Lok Sabha polls. As of 9 October 2025, the Kerala High Court has ordered the formation of a confidential *Special Investigation Team* (SIT) on 6 October, led by former Superintendent of Police S. Sasidharan and overseen by ADGP H. Venkatesh, to probe the matter comprehensively, including gold usage from 1998 onward; the SIT, directed to submit a report within six weeks, has begun interrogations (including Potti's statement on 5 October), with no arrests reported yet, though the court has confirmed evidence of theft and mandated the immediate return of artifacts to the temple. The controversy has intensified Kerala's polarized politics, blending temple governance with electoral strategy and underscoring long-standing tensions over Sabarimala's administration.[60], the former Thiruvithamkoor Devaswom Board Presidents Mr. N.Vasu and Mr. A Padmakumar arrested due to the involvements in this case.

Celibate main deity and entry of women devotees

Temple management places religious restrictions against the entry of women aged 10 to 50. This is based on the tradition of the temple to respect the celibate nature of the deity; similar restrictions are present against the entry of men on certain days or the inner sanctum in other Hindu temples such as the Pushkar Brahma Temple[61][62][63] and the Kamakhya Temple[64] in Guwahati.

According to the *Memoir of the Survey of the Travancore and Cochin States*, which was published in two volumes by the Madras government in the 19th century, women of menstruating age were denied entry into the Sabarimala temple two centuries ago. Though the authors, lieutenants of the Madras Infantry, completed the survey by the end of the year 1820 after nearly five years of research, it was published in two volumes only in 1893 and 1901. According to the report, girls and women capable of pregnancy are prohibited from approaching the temple, while elderly women and pre-pubescent girls are permitted to do so. This is due to the deity's (Ayyappan) aversion to any sexual activity in the vicinity.[65]

Up until 1991, women visited the temple, though in small numbers. Female pilgrims below the age of 50 would visit the temple to conduct (Chorroonu), the first rice-feeding ceremony of their infants in the temple's premises.[66]

In 1991, Justices K. Paripoornan and K. Balanarayana Marar of the Kerala High Court, in their ruling against the Travancore Devaswom Board, restricted the entry of women between the ages of 10 and 50 from offering worship at the temple, stating that such a restriction was in accordance with the usage prevalent from time immemorial.[38] In addition, the judges directed the Government of Kerala to use the police force to ensure that restriction was complied with.[38] The high court also stated that "since there is no restriction between one section and another section or between one class and another class among the Hindus in the matter of entry to a temple (Sabarimala), whereas the prohibition is only in respect of women of a particular age group and not women as a class."[67]

On 28 September 2018, the Supreme Court of India, in a 4-1 majority decision (4 men and 1 women judicial panel), overturned the ban on the entry of women.[68][69] The Chief Justice, Dipak Misra, stated that the selective ban on women was not an "essential part" of Hinduism but instead a form of "religious patriarchy".[68] Justice Dhananjaya Y. Chandrachud stated that the ban "stigamatises" and "stereotypes" women while "placing the burden of men's celibacy" on them.[68][70] The lone female judge, Indu Malhotra noted in her dissenting judgement that "what constitutes an essential religious practice is for the religious community to decide" and not a matter that should be decided by the courts. She added that "notions of rationality cannot be invoked in matters of religion by courts."[68][71][72] After the Supreme Court's decision, there were numerous protests and gatherings in the southern part of Kerala. In response to this ruling, devotees have filed about 65 review petitions. The Supreme Court of India accepted review petitions against its own orders. The Supreme Court has decided to review the petition and hold a public hearing because of the important facts and circumstances of the case.[73]

This led to protests at Nilakkal and Pamba base camps on 17 October 2018, when the temple was opened for the first time after the Supreme Court verdict. Protesters assaulted women journalists, stole their camera equipment, and damaged a vehicle. The police were also attacked. A number of women were among the protesters, checking cars for women of menstruating age and helping with the road blocks.[74][75] There were also reports of police damaging protesters' motor bikes.[76] Devotees in a large scale all over Kerala and in the southern state of Tamil Nadu, Andra Pradesh and Karnataka, also joined the protests.[77] As part of these protests, on 26 December 2018, devotees lit the 'Ayyappa Jyothi' across the state of Kerala and in Karnataka covering a distance of about 765 km from 6 pm to 6:30 p.m. Thousands joined in the event.[78][79] The protestors were physically attacked in Kannur and the state government filed cases against 1400 unidentified participants.[80][78]

People from other religious groups supported the cause of devotees. Prominent Jain Acharya Yugbhushan Suri Maharaj, also known as Pandit Maharaj, has said that sanctity was a religious issue and that it was connected to fundamental religious rights.[81] Commenting on the Sabarimala temple row, Pandit Maharaj told IndiaToday, "Whether it is Sabarimala or Jharkhand's Shikharji, the agitations are for sanctity," adding, "Religion talks about inner belief and sanctity. This should be respected. I am not against the judiciary or the Supreme Court, but they should not overlook the belief of the people." Also, Art of Living founder Ravi Shankar showed support for the rules that have been traditionally followed at the sanctum sanctorum of the Ayyappa Temple in Sabarimala.[82]

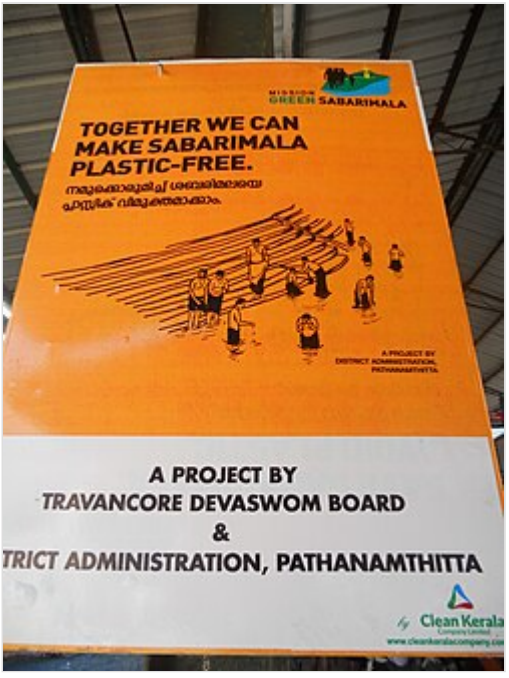
Two women of menstruating age attempted to enter the temple on 19 October 2018 but were blocked by protesters about 100 m away. After the Thantri threatened to close the sanctum sanctorum if the women attempted to ascend the 18 sacred steps, they turned back.[83][84]

On 2 January 2019 at 3:45 AM, for the first time after the Supreme Court verdict, two women in their early 40s were escorted by police into the Sabarimala temple, allegedly through a back gate meant for staff. The Chief Minister of Kerala, Pinarayi Vijayan, confirmed their entry. Thereafter, priests closed the temple for one hour to ritually purify it as the 41-days pilgrimage is known as Mandala kalam or the 41-day austerity period/Vratham had not been given a by-pass and the women entered the temple premises violating all those traditions too.[48][49][85][86][87][88]

After the hearing ended in February 2019, the Court, led by the newly appointed Chief Justice, Mr. Ranjan Gagoi, issued an order to send the case to a larger bench of seven judges so that the decision made on 28 September 2018, could be looked at again.[73]

Environmental efforts

The waste disposed by the devotees to Sabarimala is threatening the wildlife of the region[89][90][91] and the evergreen forests.[92] Efforts are on to make Sabarimala free from pollution and waste. High Court of Kerala has directed that 'Irumudikkettu' should not contain plastic materials.[93] Projects like "Punyam Poonkavanam" has been initiated under the aegis of governmental departments.[94] Mata Amritanandamayi Math has been regularly contributing to keep Sabarimala and its precincts clean.[95][96] While cleaning Pamba river Sabarimala Sanndidhaanam clean is their primary objective,[97] the broader vision is to spread the message of greenness and cleanliness beyond Sabarimala.[98]



An information signage near Nadappanthal, Sabarimala, inviting all to join hands in making Sabarimala free from plastic and other wastes.

Some of the salient aspects of "*Punyam Poonkavanam*" project includes:[99]

1. Not using soap and oil while bathing in the holy Pamba River. No throwing any material, including clothes in the holy river.
2. To prepare *irumudikkettu* without using any plastic and using only bio-degradable materials.
3. To devote at least one hour in cleanliness activities at Sabarimala Sannidhaanam, River Pamba and surroundings as part of the pilgrimage.

See also

- Sabarimala Temple complex
  - Maalikapurathamma, Hindu goddess enshrined in a small temple at Sabarimala Ayyappan temple complex
  - Sabarimala Trek, pilgrimage track

- Vavar, a Muslim devotee of Sabarimala with shrine in Sabarimala temple complex

- Hinduism
  - Hindu pilgrimage sites
  - List of Hindu temples

References

1. "Home | Sabarimala" (https://sabarimala.kerala.gov.in/). *sabarimala.kerala.gov.in*. Retrieved 21 January 2024.
2. "Mohini – The Only Female Avatar of Lord Vishnu" (https://vedicfeed.com/mohini-female-avatar-of-lord-vishnu/). Vedicfeed. 4 August 2019.
3. "The Story Of Sabarimala: Origin, Beliefs And Controversy Over Women Entry" (https://www.ndtv.com/kerala-news/the-story-of-sabarimala-origin-beliefs-and-controversy-on-women-entry-1933477). *NDTV.com*. Retrieved 2 November 2023.
4. "Why millions throng Sabarimala shrine" (https://web.archive.org/web/20110116063414/http://daily.bhaskar.com/article/NAT-TOP-why-millions-throng-sabarimala-shrine-1755207.html). *DailyBhaskar*. 15 January 2011. Archived from the original (http://daily.bhaskar.com/article/NAT-TOP-why-millions-throng-sabarimala-shrine-1755207.html) on 16 January 2011. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
5. "Indo-Americans shocked at Sabarimala tragedy" (https://web.archive.org/web/20110515015423/http://www.sify.com/news/indo-americans-shocked-at-sabarimala-tragedy-news-international-lbpqadcabij.html). *Sify*. Archived from the original (http://www.sify.com/news/indo-americans-shocked-at-sabarimala-tragedy-news-international-lbpqadcabij.html) on 15 May 2011. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
6. "Record collection at Sabarimala" (https://web.archive.org/web/20181021232303/https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/record-collection-at-sabarimala/article6730315.ece). *The Hindu*. 27 December 2014. Archived from the original (https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/record-collection-at-sabarimala/article6730315.ece) on 21 October 2018.
7. "Women to enter Sabarimala temple today: Weird laws against women from all over the world" (https://www.indiatoday.in/education-today/gk-current-affairs/story/sabarimala-temple-ends-ban-on-women-kerala-1351711-2018-09-28). India Today. 28 September 2018.
8. "Sabarimala Temple Opening Dates 2018 to 2019 – Chennaivision" (https://web.archive.org/web/20180113035503/https://chennaivision.com/sabarimala-temple-opening-dates-2018/). *Chennaivision*. 1 January 2018. Archived from the original (https://chennaivision.com/sabarimala-temple-opening-dates-2018/) on 13 January 2018. Retrieved 16 January 2018.
9. CK, Faisal (20 November 2018). "Sabarimala epitomises confluence of various faiths in India" (https://www.nationalheraldindia.com/opinion/sabarimala-epitomises-confluence-of-various-faiths-in-india). *National Herald*. Retrieved 2 November 2023.
10. Abraham, Korah (29 March 2019). "Sabarimala case petitioner was a BJP member: Kerala minister alleges conspiracy" (https://www.thenewsminute.com/kerala/sabarimala-case-petitioner-was-bjp-member-kerala-minister-alleges-conspiracy-99136). *The News Minute*. Retrieved 27 September 2025.
11. Rao, T.A. Gopinath (1914). *Elements of Hindu Iconography*. Delhi: Dalcassian Publishing Company. pp. Vol.Two, Part II, p.486–487.
12. Jayashankar, S (1997). *Temples of Kerala*. Trivandrum: Directorate of Census Operations. p. 159.
13. *Asian Mythologies* |Yves Bonnefoy |University of Chicago Press, 15 May 1993

14. "Shrines for Sastha, in eight forms" (http://www.thehindu.com/features/friday-review/history-and-culture/shrines-for-sastha-in-eight-forms/article5425348.ece). *The Hindu*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
15. Vaidyanathan, K.R (1982). *Temple and Legends of Kerala*. BHARATIYA VIDYA BHAVAN. pp. 70–75.
16. Sekar, Radhika (1992). *The Sabarimalai Pilgrimage ad Ayyappan Cultus* (1st ed.). Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass Publishers Private limited. p. 19. ISBN 81-208-1056-2.
17. Sekar, Radhika (1992). *The Sabarimali Pilgrimage and Ayyappan Cultus* (1st ed.). Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass Publishers Private Limited. pp. 15–16. ISBN 81-208-1056-2.
18. "In Memory of a Warrior Deity" (https://www.newindianexpress.com/magazine/2015/jan/24/in-memory-of-a-warrior-deity-709189.html). *The New Indian Express*. 24 January 2015. Retrieved 1 June 2016.
19. "Malikappurathamma Malikappuram Temple Sabarimala" (https://web.archive.org/web/20160604233409/http://www.vaikhari.org/malikappurathamma.html). *Vaikhari*. Archived from the original (http://www.vaikhari.org/malikappurathamma.html) on 4 June 2016. Retrieved 1 June 2016.
20. "Sabarimala verdict: When Hindus fight, they lose invariably" (https://www.mynation.com/views/sabarimala-verdict-hindu-leftists-liberals-supreme-court-kerala-temple-pfx1n9). *My nation*. Retrieved 1 June 2020.
21. "ഐതിഹ്യങ്ങളിലെ ചീരപ്പൻ ചിറ തറവാട്" (https://tv.mathrubhumi.com/news/kerala/-cheerappan-chira-tharavad--1.123938) [The legendary Cheerappan Chira Tharavaud]. *Mathrubumi* (in Malayalam). Retrieved 1 June 2020.
22. "ശബരിമല ചരിത്രവും വിശ്വാസവും" (https://neritam.com/2019/07/03/sabarimala-history-belief/) [Sabarimala History and Beliefs]. *Neritam* (in Malayalam). 3 July 2019. Retrieved 1 June 2020.
23. "What you might want to know about Sabarimala" (https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/et-explains/what-you-might-want-to-know-about-sabarimala/articleshow/66273712.cms). *The Economic Times*. 18 October 2018. ISSN 0013-0389 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0013-0389). Retrieved 20 March 2023.
24. "Why Lord Ayyappa shrine is called Sabarimala temple" (https://www.indiatoday.in/india/story/why-lord-ayyappa-shrine-is-called-sabarimala-temple-1390621-2018-11-17). *India Today*. 17 November 2018. Retrieved 20 March 2023.
25. Pandalam adamaanam, Malayalam year 969, in T.K. Velupillai, Travancore
26. Benjamin Swain Ward; Peter Eyre Conner (1863). *Memoir of the survey of Travancore and Cochin states, Vol. 1*. p. 136.
27. Balslev, Anindita N. (2014). *On World Religions: Diversity, not Dissension* (1st ed.). Sage Publications India Pvt. Ltd. p. 218. ISBN 9788132118343.
28. Menon, K Kesava (1950). *Sabarimala Temple Arson Case* (http://firstministry.kerala.gov.in/wp-content/uploads/pdf/bills/Reports/tmple_arsn.pdf) (PDF). Trivandrum: Government Press. Retrieved 8 January 2020.
29. Jeffrey, Robin (1980). "What the Statues Tell: The Politics of Choosing Symbols in Trivandrum". *Pacific Affairs*. **53** (3): 494. doi:10.2307/2757305 (https://doi.org/10.2307%2F2757305). JSTOR 2757305 (https://www.jstor.org/stable/2757305).
30. "Adivasis stake a claim on Sabarimala" (https://www.forwardpress.in/2018/12/adivasis-stake-a-claim-on-sabarimala/). 24 December 2018.
31. Clothey, Fred W.; A. K. Ramanujan (1978). *The Many Faces of Murukaṉ: The History and Meaning of a South Indian God*. Walter De Gruyter. p. 201. ISBN 978-90-279-7632-1.
32. Kumar, S. Vijay (21 May 2006). "Madurai mourns its colossal boss" (https://web.archive.org/web/20070514063306/http://www.hindu.com/2006/05/21/stories/2006052106160400.htm). *The Hindu*. Chennai, India. Archived from the original (http://www.hindu.com/2006/05/21/stories/2006052106160400.htm) on 14 May 2007.

33. "My 'choroonu' was in Sabarimala on my mother's lap: TKA Nair" (https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/thiruvananthapuram/my-choroonu-was-in-sabarimala-on-my-mothers-lap-tka-nair/articleshow/66003421.cms). Retrieved 5 March 2020.
34. "Master Plan for Sabarimala Built Fabric Analysis Module" (https://ntca.gov.in/assets/uploads/Reports/sabarimala/Vol2_Mod4_Built_frabric_analysis_module.pdf) (PDF).
35. "Sannidhanam sabarimala meaning | Brief on sabarimala sannidhanam" (http://lordayyappa.com/sabarimala/sannidhanam-sabarimala.php). *lordayyappa.com*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
36. "Sabarimala-The pilgrimage is a symbol of love, equality, and devotion" (http://www.sabarimala.org/sannidhanam.htm). *www.sabarimala.org*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
37. "Sabarimala Temple's Mandala-Makaravilakku season: The significance of the temple among the pilgrims" (https://www.news9live.com/knowledge/sabarimala-temple-mandala-makaravilakku-season-the-significance-of-the-temple-among-the-pilgrims-2352719). *News9live*. 17 November 2023. Retrieved 7 December 2023.
38. Kerala High Court (5 April 1991) Bench: K Paripoornan, K B Marar; Source: [1] (https://indiankanoon.org/doc/1915943/) (accessed Sunday 1 May 2016)
39. "Malikappurathamma Malikappuram Temple Sabarimala" (https://web.archive.org/web/20160604233409/http://www.vaikhari.org/malikappurathamma.html). *www.vaikhari.org*. Archived from the original on 4 June 2016. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
40. https://www.thenewsminute.com/kerala/kerala-hc-says-temple-priesthood-cannot-be-restricted-to-caste-or-lineage
41. "Travancore Devaswom Board Permits More Devotees to Visit Sabarimala Temple, Covid-19 Test Mandatory" (https://www.news18.com/news/india/travancore-devaswom-board-to-permit-more-devotees-to-visit-sabarimala-temple-covid-19-test-mandatory-3135395.html). *News18*. 1 December 2020. Retrieved 3 December 2020.
42. Kerala government approves Rs 1033 crore Sabarimala Master Plan Read more at: https://english.mathrubhumi.com/news/kerala/kerala-government-approves-rupees-1033-crore-sabarimala-master-plan-19c7bb6d (https://english.mathrubhumi.com/news/kerala/kerala-government-approves-rupees-1033-crore-sabarimala-master-plan-19c7bb6d), mathrubhumi.com, 9 January 2025.
43. "Tattva Bodha in a Nutshell by Peter Bonnici" (http://www.advaita.org.uk/discourses/teachers/tattvabodha_bonnici.htm).
44. JITHEESH, P.M (2022). *Sabarimala - Social History of a temple in Kerala*. LeftWord. pp. 86–89. ISBN 978-81-940778-3-1.
45. "Sabarimala prasadam to get 'makeover' with CFTRI touch" (https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/sabarimala-prasadam-to-get-makeover-with-cftri-touch/articleshow/63960227.cms). *The Economic Times*. 29 April 2018. ISSN 0013-0389 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0013-0389). Retrieved 9 November 2023.
46. "CFTRI to monitor quality of Sabarimala prasadom" (http://www.thehindu.com/news/states/kerala/article3731927.ece). 6 August 2012.
47. P.M, Jitheesh (2022). *Sabarimala - Social History Of a Temple in Kerala* (1st ed.). New Delhi: LeftWord. p. 127. ISBN 978-81-940778-3-1.
48. nedunal (14 February 2017). "Sabarimala Opening Dates 2020" (https://web.archive.org/web/20200102054151/https://nedunal.com/sabarimala-temple-opening-dates/). *nedunal*. Archived from the original (https://nedunal.com/sabarimala-temple-opening-dates/) on 2 January 2020. Retrieved 2 January 2020.
49. "Hainda vakeralam" (https://web.archive.org/web/20111002214507/http://www.haindavakeralam.com/HKPage.aspx?PageID=12948&SKIN=D). Archived from the original (http://www.haindavakeralam.com/HKPage.aspx?PageID=12948&SKIN=D) on 2 October 2011. Retrieved 23 July 2011.

50. "Sabarimala Temple Opening Dates 2018 to 2019" (https://dheivegam.com/sabarimala-temple-opening-dates/). Dheivegam. 16 March 2020.
51. Singh, Ram Kinkar (15 October 2018). "Sabarimala temple: Here is why devotees of Lord Ayyappa are protesting in Delhi" (https://www.indiatoday.in/india/story/sabarimala-temple-here-is-why-devotees-of-lord-ayyappa-are-protesting-in-delhi-1368109-2018-10-15). *India Today*. Retrieved 13 November 2019.
52. "Rituals | Sabarimala" (https://www.sabarimala.kerala.gov.in/rituals). *www.sabarimala.kerala.gov.in*. Retrieved 7 December 2023.
53. Mosque of Vavar in Sabrimala (21 February 2020). "Mosque of vavar" (https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/before-arriving-at-sabarimala-temple-in-kerala-devotees-visit-a-mosque/articleshow/50334905.cms). *Economic Times*.
54. "For Sabarimala's dolly bearers, the demanding work is also a godsend" (https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/kerala/2022/dec/16/for-sabarimalas-dolly-bearers-the-demanding-work-is-also-a-godsend-2528568.html). *The New Indian Express*. 15 December 2022. Retrieved 7 December 2023.
55. Zee Media Bureau (31 December 2022). "Kerala to have new airport near Sabarimala temple, govt approves land acquisition" (https://zeenews.india.com/aviation/kerala-to-have-new-airport-near-sabarimala-temple-govt-approves-land-acquisition-2556143.html). *Zeenews.India.Com*. Retrieved 31 December 2022.
56. "About 17230/29 Sabari Express" (https://www.travelkhana.com/rail-info/about-1723029-sabari-express/). *Indian Rail Info by TravelKhana*. 22 December 2022. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20220625224457/https://www.travelkhana.com/rail-infoabout-1723029-sabari-express/) from the original on 25 June 2022. Retrieved 23 March 2024.
57. "Buses to Sabarimala from TN" (https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/chennai/buses-to-sabarimala-from-tn/articleshow/95568641.cms). *The Times of India*. 17 November 2022. ISSN 0971-8257 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0971-8257). Retrieved 21 November 2023.
58. "All arrangements in place for Sabarimala pilgrimage" (https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/all-arrangements-in-place-for-sabarimala-pilgrimage/article67532686.ece). *The Hindu*. 14 November 2023. ISSN 0971-751X (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0971-751X). Retrieved 21 November 2023.
59. Sabarimala ropeway project nears final clearance (https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/kerala/2025/Aug/27/sabarimala-ropeway-project-nears-final-clearance-4), New Indian Express, 27 Aug 2025.
60. Poll season on horizon, Sabarimala gold ‘theft’ stirs the pot in Kerala. UDF takes on ruling LDF (https://theprint.in/politics/poll-season-on-horizon-sabarimala-gold-theft-stirs-the-pot-in-kerala-udf-takes-on-ruling-ldf/2759431/), The Print, 8 Oct 2025.
61. Sultania, Devyani (29 November 2016). "Here's a list of 8 temples in India where men are not allowed to enter!" (https://www.ibtimes.co.in/heres-list-8-temples-india-where-men-are-not-allowed-enter-706187). *International Business Times, India Edition*. Retrieved 13 November 2019.
62. "Indian temples where men can't enter on certain days" (https://web.archive.org/web/20190718102559/https://www.newindianexpress.com/nation/2018/sep/28/indian-temples-where-men-cant-enter-on-certain-days-1878292.html). *The New Indian Express*. Archived from the original (https://www.newindianexpress.com/nation/2018/sep/28/indian-temples-where-men-cant-enter-on-certain-days-1878292.html) on 18 July 2019. Retrieved 13 November 2019.
63. "NO ENTRY: 6 Temples In India Where MEN Are Not Allowed To Enter Or Worship" (https://web.archive.org/web/20200131052943/https://daily.bhaskar.com/news/JM-RIT-temples-where-men-not-allowed-5533092-PHO.html). *dailybhaskar*. 20 February 2017. Archived from the original (https://daily.bhaskar.com/news/JM-RIT-temples-where-men-not-allowed-5533092-PHO.html) on 31 January 2020. Retrieved 13 November 2019.

64. "Indian temples where men can't enter on certain days" (https://web.archive.org/web/20190718102559/https://www.newindianexpress.com/nation/2018/sep/28/indian-temples-where-men-cant-enter-on-certain-days-1878292.html). *The New Indian Express*. Archived from the original (https://www.newindianexpress.com/nation/2018/sep/28/indian-temples-where-men-cant-enter-on-certain-days-1878292.html) on 18 July 2019. Retrieved 13 November 2019.
65. "British era survey report says Sabarimala ban existed 200 years ago" (https://www.theweek.in/news/india/2018/11/22/british-era-survey-report-says-sabarimala-ban-existed-200-years-ago.html). *The Week*.
66. Gilles Tarabout (2015). "Religious Uncertainty, Astrology and the Courts in South India" (https://hal.archives-ouvertes.fr/hal-01246885/document). In Berti, Daniella; Good, Anthony; Tarabout, Gilles (eds.). *Of Doubt and Proof. Legal and Ritual Practices of Judgmen*. Ashgate. pp. 70–71. ISBN 978-1-4724-3451-7. Retrieved 29 October 2018.
67. "S. Mahendran vs The Secretary, Travancore ... on 5 April, 1991" (https://indiankanoon.org/doc/1915943/). *indiankanoon.org*.
68. The Registrar, SCI. "Writ petition (civil) no. 373 of 2006" (https://web.archive.org/web/20181019154645/https://www.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2006/18956/18956_2006_Judgement_28-Sep-2018.pdf) (PDF). *Supreme Court of India*. Archived from the original (https://www.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2006/18956/18956_2006_Judgement_28-Sep-2018.pdf) (PDF) on 19 October 2018. Retrieved 15 December 2018.
69. "Women Of All Ages Can Enter Sabarimala Temple, Says Top Court, Ending Ban" (https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/keralas-sabarimala-temple-must-allow-women-of-all-ages-says-supreme-court-ending-restriction-1923556). *NDTV.com*. Retrieved 28 September 2018.
70. "SC allows entry of women of all ages to worship at Sabarimala, other places of their choice" (https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/sabarimala-temple-entry-live-updates/article25066336.ece). *The Hindu*. 28 September 2018 – via www.thehindu.com.
71. "Sabarimala verdict: Justice Indu Malhotra dissents — Can't invoke rationality in religion" (https://indianexpress.com/article/india/sabarimala-verdict-justice-indu-malhotra-dissents-cant-invoke-rationality-in-religion-5378873/). *The Indian Express*. 29 September 2018. Retrieved 24 November 2018.
72. "Sabarimala verdict: 5 key reasons why Justice Indu Malhotra differed with majority view - Times of India" (https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/sabarimala-verdict-5-key-reasons-why-justice-indu-malhotra-differed-with-majority-view/articleshow/65997997.cms). *The Times of India*. Retrieved 24 November 2018.
73. "Supreme Court verdict tomorrow on plea challenging Sabarimala ruling" (https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/supreme-court-will-tomorrow-decide-review-petitions-on-entry-of-women-into-sabarimala-temple-rafale-deal/story-trKUAzgAC0kFGkCpG3qucJ.html). *Hindustan Times*. 13 November 2019. Retrieved 28 February 2023.
74. "Sabarimala row: Devotees attack journalists, stop women from approaching temple" (https://m.hindustantimes.com/india-news/tension-mounts-in-kerala-as-sabarimala-set-to-open-today/story-YRZuiWacJvlZc8Agn1gfJK.html). *Hindustan Times*. Retrieved 17 October 2018.
75. "Sabarimala: Mobs attack women near India Hindu temple" (https://www.bbc.com/news/world-asia-india-45885996). *BBC*. Retrieved 17 October 2018.
76. "Watch: Kerala Cops Vandalise Parked Vehicles Near Sabarimala" (https://www.ndtv.com/kerala-news/watch-kerala-cops-vandalise-parked-vehicles-near-sabarimala-1933642). *NDTV.com*. Retrieved 15 November 2018.
77. " 'Peaceful' protests against Supreme Court judgment" (https://www.deccanchronicle.com/nation/current-affairs/021018/peaceful-protests-against-supreme-court-judgment.html). *Deccan Chronicle*. 2 October 2018. Retrieved 21 June 2019.
78. "To counter Women's Wall, Ayyappa Jyothi volunteers line up with lamps across Kerala" (https://www.thenewsminute.com/article/counter-women-s-wall-ayyappa-jyothi-volunteers-line-lamps-across-kerala-94029). *www.thenewsminute.com*. 26 December 2018. Retrieved 21 June 2019.

79. "Massive participation of women in 765-km Ayyappa Jyothi" (https://english.manoramaonline.com/news/kerala/2018/12/26/ayyappa-jyothi-sabarimala-karma-samithi-kerala.html). *OnManorama*. Retrieved 21 June 2019.
80. "Cases filed against 1400 people who took part in Ayyappa Jyothi event in Kerala" (https://www.thenewsminute.com/article/cases-filed-against-1400-people-who-took-part-ayyappa-jyothi-event-kerala-94219). *www.thenewsminute.com*. 30 December 2018. Retrieved 21 June 2019.
81. Pankaj P. Khelkar (18 October 2018). "Women should not enter Sabarimala: Jain acharya Pandit Maharaj" (https://www.indiatoday.in/india/story/women-should-not-enter-sabarimala-jain-acharya-pandit-maharaj-1370232-2018-10-18). *India Today*. Retrieved 4 March 2019.
82. "Tradition must be followed: Sri Sri Ravi Shankar on Sabarimala row" (https://www.indiatoday.in/india/story/tradition-must-be-followed-sri-sri-ravi-shankar-on-sabarimala-row-1382273-2018-11-04). *India Today*. Ist. Retrieved 4 March 2019.
83. "Sabarimala protests: Women descend the hill without darshan following protests" (https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/sabarimala-women-entry-issue-protests-continue/article25258611.ece). *The Hindu*. Retrieved 19 October 2018.
84. Berlinger, Joshua; Pokharel, Sugam; Suri, Manveena (2 January 2019). "Two Indian women become first to enter temple after centuries-old ban overturned" (https://www.cnn.com/2019/01/01/asia/india-kerala-chain-intl/index.html). *CNN*.
85. "Two women below 50 claim they entered Kerala's Sabarimala temple - Times of India ►" (https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/two-women-below-50-claim-they-entered-keralas-sabarimala-temple/articleshow/67343779.cms). *The Times of India*. 2 January 2019. Retrieved 2 January 2019.
86. "2 Women Below 50 Enter Sabarimala, Temple Reopens After "Purification" " (https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/two-women-below-50-enter-keralas-sabarimala-temple-police-sources-1971204). *NDTV.com*. Retrieved 2 January 2019.
87. P, Chennabasaveshwar (28 September 2018). "Sabarimala Temple entry case: Jayamala's bold claim that stoked controversy in 2006" (https://www.oneindia.com/india/sabarimala-temple-entry-case-jayamala-s-bold-claim-that-stoked-controversy-in-2006-2784013.html). *OneIndia*. Retrieved 24 June 2019.
88. M.G, Radhakrishnan (15 January 1995). "Ban on women of prohibited age group visiting Sabarimala shrine comes under scrutiny" (https://www.indiatoday.in/magazine/religion/story/19950115-ban-on-women-of-prohibited-age-group-visiting-sabarimala-shrine-comes-under-scrutiny-806703-1995-01-15). *India Today*. Retrieved 20 October 2018.
89. "ശബരിമലയിൽ ചത്ത മ്ലാവിന്റെ വയറ്റിൽ കിലോക്കണക്കിന് പ്ലാസ്റ്റിക്ക്" (https://web.archive.org/web/20160314131309/http://mathrubhuminews.in/ee/ReadMore/22360/sabarimala-news/E). *mathrubhuminews.in*. Archived from the original (http://mathrubhuminews.in/ee/ReadMore/22360/sabarimala-news/E) on 14 March 2016. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
90. "Going green? Kerala's Sabarimala temple rules against the use of plastics – Firstpost" (http://www.firstpost.com/india/going-green-keralas-sabarimala-temple-rules-against-the-use-of-plastics-2585534.html). *Firstpost*. 15 January 2016. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
91. "Kerala High Court seeks probe into deer death" (https://www.deccanchronicle.com/160107/nation-current-affairs/article/kerala-high-court-seeks-probe-deer-death). *Deccan Chronicle*. 7 January 2016. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
92. "Sabarimala and Periyar eternal yet threatened" (http://blogs.timesofindia.indiatimes.com/plumage/sabarimala-and-periyar-eternal-yet-threatened/). *Times Of India Blogs*. 22 June 2014. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
93. " 'Irumudikkettu' should not contain plastic materials: HC" (http://english.mathrubhumi.com/news/kerala/-irumudikkettu-should-not-contain-plastic-materials-hc-english-news-1.737230). *Mathrubhumi*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.

94. Vijayan, P. " 'Punyam Poonkavanam' to cleanse Sabarimala" (http://english.mathrubhumi.com/features/specials/-punyam-poonkavanam-to-cleanse-sabarimala-english-news-1.673800). *Mathrubhumi*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
95. "Sabarimala clean-up: 35,000 bags of garbage collected" (http://www.ndtv.com/south/sabarimala-clean-up-35-000-bags-of-garbage-collected-505984). *NDTV.com*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
96. Kuttoor, Radhakrishnan. "200 foreigners take part in cleaning drive at Sabarimala" (http://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/200-foreigners-take-part-in-cleaning-drive-at-sabarimala/article2609299.ece). *The Hindu*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
97. Special Correspondent. "Pampa to be included in Punyam Poonkavanam" (http://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/pampa-to-be-included-in-punyam-poonkavanam/article6610924.ece). *The Hindu*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.
98. "Ayyappa Seva Samajam conducts cleaning operation in Sabarimala" (http://www.uniindia.com/ayyappa-seva-samajam-conducts-cleaning-operation-in-sabarimala/other/news/351754.html). Retrieved 17 April 2023.
99. "Welcome to Official Site of Punyam Poonkavanam" (http://www.punyampoonkavanam.org/vm.php). *www.punyampoonkavanam.org*. Retrieved 2 December 2016.

External links

- Official Website Of Sabarimala (http://www.sabarimala.kerala.gov.in/)

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Sabarimala_Temple&oldid=1324061871"